

What the Sprint delivery app is for

SPRINT COURIERS · DELIVERY PROJECT · FRAME



One page, written 14 September 2026 by Luther Roberts, for the leadership and the IT department.

WHERE WE ALREADY STAND

Sprint carries about 76 percent of the courier mail volume in this country, by the regulator's own annual report. We hold the commercial postal licence. Our own company profile says over 50 branches, and counting the branch pages it is 57 offices and service points in Botswana with another three in South Africa. The banks and the land boards are already ours, on contract. We are not a new company trying to get into delivery. We are the company that already does the delivering.

WHAT IS HAPPENING AROUND US

Two small apps in Gaborone are quietly taking the part of the market that talks to ordinary people every day. Wanzu sells food, groceries, liquor and household items, and in April this year Pick n Pay chose them to carry deliveries. Zebras Delivery is doing the same on electric scooters. Neither of them owns a single branch outside Gaborone. Neither of them can carry a parcel to Maun tomorrow morning. But every week they are becoming the name a customer thinks of first when something needs to come to the door.

That is the risk. Not that they take our contracts. That they take the habit.

THE QUESTION THIS APP ANSWERS

The question is not how Sprint beats a food delivery app. It is this. How does the company that already carries the country's parcels sell the same riders, the same branches and the same licence to shops, pharmacies and households, and keep newcomers from owning the customer relationship while we are looking the other way.

WHAT WE ARE ACTUALLY BUILDING

One engine underneath, with several ways to place an order on top. A customer can order on a web page with no download, inside WhatsApp, from a shop's own website, or by walking into a branch. Behind all of them sits the same order, the same rider, the same tracking and the same money. We are not building a food app. We are adding a consumer layer to infrastructure we already paid for.

THE FOUR THINGS ONLY WE CAN DO

1. **Medicines properly.** A pharmacist dispenses and seals, our rider checks the patient's identity at the door, and a cold box logs its own temperature for anything that needs it. Nobody in this market does that. One company charges 89 pula a time just to bring a repeat prescription.
2. **Groceries and parcels in the same app.** Your weekly shopping and your document to Francistown, one account, one rider network.
3. **The whole country.** Gaborone is where a pilot starts. 57 offices and service points is where it ends.
4. **Corporate on invoice.** The banks and public bodies we already serve can order in the same system and be billed monthly, on the cost centres they already use.

WHAT WE ARE ASKING FOR RIGHT NOW

Very little. Two names, an IT lead and someone in finance who can sign off how merchants get paid. Barbara's real cost lines so we know what one delivery actually costs us and what is left over. Then a small pilot in two or three parts of Gaborone, running for eight weeks, measured honestly.

HOW WE WILL KNOW IF IT WORKED

Six numbers, agreed before we start, not after. Whether shops accept orders inside two minutes. Whether nine deliveries in ten arrive inside 45 minutes. Whether fewer than three in a hundred fail. Whether a quarter of customers come back. Whether each order leaves money behind after the rider is paid. And whether we reach 150 grocery orders a day. If the numbers are there, we roll it through the branches. If they are not, we stop, and we will have learned what the market actually wants for the cost of a pilot instead of the cost of a platform.

THE ONE THING THAT WILL SLOW US DOWN

Right now one person is building this. Until the IT department puts a name against it, every week the plan predicts is a guess.